F3 BUILDING SURVEYORS

BUILDING SURVEY REPORT

The Co-Proprietors per Trinity Factors

39 Caledonian Crescent, James Square, Edinburgh
Project Number: 21049
Date: 30-Nov-21
Revision: Not applicable

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39 CALEDONIAN CRESCENT, JAMES SQUARE, EDINBURGH

BUILDING SURVEY REPORT

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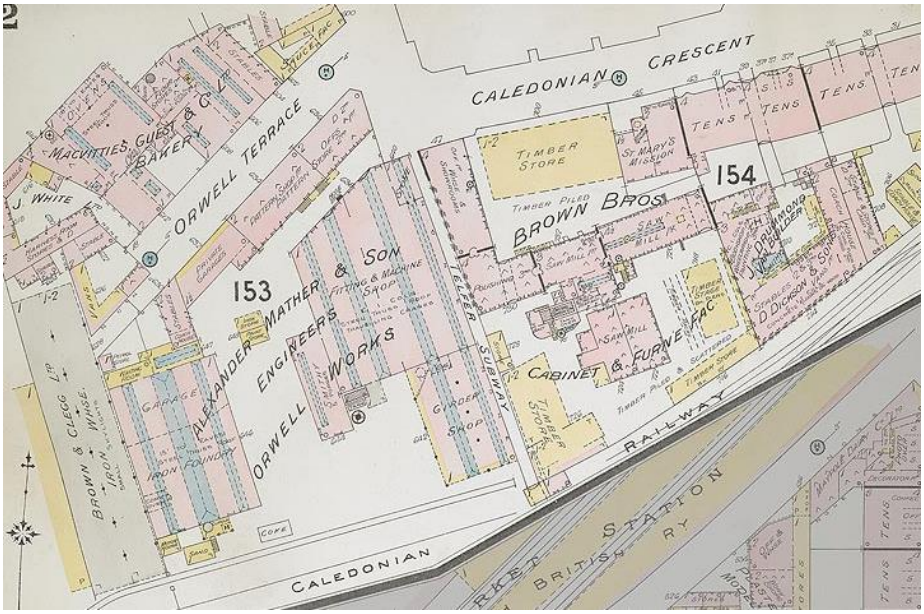
This report has been prepared by F3 Building Surveyors Limited with all reasonable skill, care and diligence, within the terms of the Contract with the Client. The report is confidential to the Client and F3 Building Surveyors Limited accepts no responsibility of whatever nature to third parties to whom this report may be made known.

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1. On behalf of The Co-Proprietors per Trinity Factors, we were requested to undertake a building fabric survey to the roof area of the property comprising 39 Caledonian Crescent, part of the James Square development, Edinburgh.

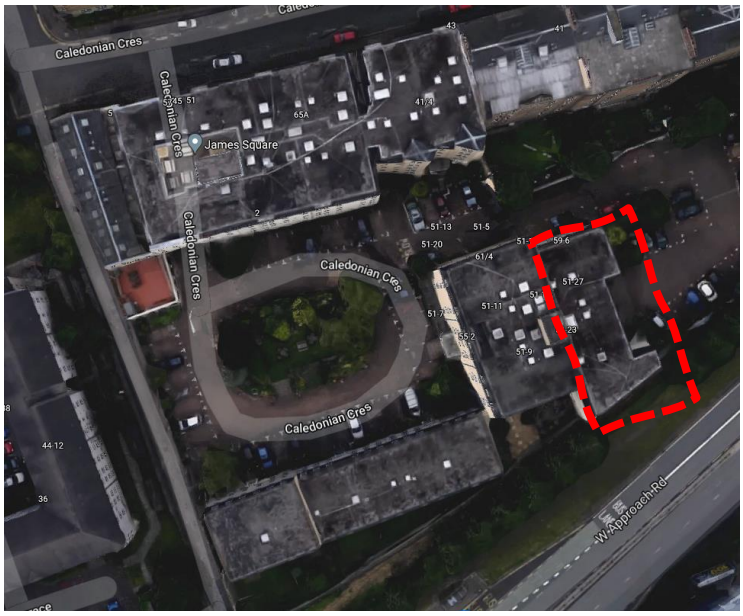
1.2. We undertook our survey on 14th October 2021, this was undertaken by David Bonar, MRICS, Chartered Building Surveyor and Sally Orr, MRICS, Chartered Building Surveyor, with access provided by the on site co-ordinator.

1.3. The property comprises a flatted residential block within a larger development, the block in question is over four floors. Our understanding is that the properties are on the site of a former timber store and sawmill / furniture works (see map below). The property is not a listed building and neither is it within a Conservation Area.



1.4. The property appears to be traditionally constructed with a wet dash wall finish, slated mansard sections at the top floor and the roof is of a flat roof construction.

1.5. The property is located on Caledonian Crescent, Edinburgh.



1. INTRODUCTION (cont)

1.6. We were given access to the following areas:

1.6.1. External fabric: Please refer to our separate report with regard to elevations.

1.6.2. Roof coverings: We were able to undertake an inspection via access through the common stair hatch to block 39 to the flat roof coverings. To the mansard slated sections, we were able to undertake a ground level inspection as well as where possible, access available utilizing the cherry picker which was used for the elevation surveys.

1.6.3. External curtilage: Not applicable for the purpose of our survey.

1.6.4. Internally: Not applicable for the purpose of our survey.

1.7. Areas of no access: We gained access to all relevant areas for the purposes of the survey.

1.8. For the purposes of the report, the front elevation to the property to the property is assumed to face east. All references to left hand side and right hand side are taken when viewing the relevant elevation from external facing the building.

1.9. We were not provided with any Health and Safety file nor the Operation & Maintenance Manual for the building. We have not been provided with any information for example builders estimates or the like.

1.10. Please note that this report is not intended for issue to contractors for pricing works. In the event that the owners decide to proceed with the works we would strongly recommend that full and comprehensive tender documentation be prepared, we can undertake this if required.

2. GENERAL OBSERVATIONS

2.1. The building is generally in a good condition however the roof coverings now require some repair:

2.1.1. Flat roof: The flat roof comprises a mastic asphalt finish with limestone chippings laid over. Mastic asphalt is generally a hard-wearing good quality roof covering, achieving a life span of 50 years plus. The roof drains towards the outside at the platform edge with the slatework mansard section. To the areas where the asphalt was visible, it appeared in a fair condition, there was some minor cracking / opening up to exposed areas of asphalt however generally fair, we have allowed for short term repairs to maintain watertightness. There have been previous feltwork and liquid plastic repairs to the south of the roof at the platform edge, these felt patches appear to be in a fair condition and we would assume that they have been installed in response to water ingress.

2.1.2. In the short term we have allowed for a core test to the mastic asphalt, to determine the build-up of the roof covering. This is to confirm whether there is the required sheathing membrane in place, and what the existing roof deck substrate comprises of e.g. plywood, concrete or the like. Depending on the outcome of the core test, will determine the possible longer-term works. At this time assuming the roof is installed as it should be, we have included in the medium term to allow for removal of the limestone chippings and repair works. At this time, we have included for a re-cover / overlay over the mastic asphalt in either a liquid plastic type finish or a felt covering. At the same time, we have also included for provision of insulation to the roof area.

2.1.3. Flashings: To the roof there are lead cover flashings and lead platform edge. The cover flashings are in a fair condition, there has been sections which have split / torn and the pointing to the leadwork requires some repair in the short term. We have allowed for replacement of the leadwork at the same time as the re-covering of the roof covering in the medium term. There appears to have been replacement sky lights carried out to individual properties and around these there have been felt patches provided, generally these are in a fair condition.

Photo 01 – General view of the roof

Photo 02 – Large access hatch, requiring strut for safety.

2.1.4. Access hatch: The roof is accessed from a large skylight within the common stair, we have allowed for in the short term a strut to promote safe access as the roof light is extremely large and at the moment is unable to be propped up / restrained to allow safe access. See photograph 02 above. We have allowed in the medium term in conjunction with overlay of the flat roof, replacement of the large access hatch.

2. GENERAL OBSERVATIONS (cont)

Photo 03 – Vegetation growth

Photo 04 – Previous repairs with felt.

Photo 05 – Cracking at upstand.

Photo 06 – Guttering requiring repair

2.1.5. Rooflights generally: These are in a fair condition, and there appears to have been replacement works carried out by individual owners. At the time of overlay in the medium term, it is anticipated there may be a requirement for skylights to be replaced, we have allowed for these in the medium term.

2.1.6. Vegetation growth: There is vegetation growth to the lime chippings to the roof, in the short term we have allowed for this to be removed.

2.1.7. There are various vent pipes, generally these are in a fair condition. At the time of any increased insulation, there will be a requirement to extend six of these, we have included this within the costs.

2.1.8. Mansard slate sections: These are in a fair condition, and we would recommend that any slipped slates are replaced when required and these are annually inspected. We have included for the slate repairs within our budget costs.

2.1.9. Guttering: We have allowed for the guttering to be cleared out and a sum for repairs as there are signs of leaking guttering, especially below the area of block 55 adjacent where render patching has been carried out and sections have fallen into the gutter.

3. RECOMMENDED WORKS

3.1. Our recommendations would be to undertake the repairs as required to the following areas:

RED PRIORITY: IMMEDIATE / SHORT TERM (YEARS 1-2):

3.2. In terms of immediate / short term actions we would recommend the following:

3.2.1. Asbestos: We have included for an asbestos refurbishment survey to the roof prior to repairs.

3.2.2. Undertake core test to determine the roof build up. Undertake minor repairs to mastic asphalt, locally there are no contractors who are able to carry out mastic asphalt repairs, previously Lenaghan Roofing Services Ltd were able to undertake these however we have spoken with them, and they confirmed that they are no longer undertaking mastic asphalt repairs. There are companies in the west of the country and in England however no local contractors. On other projects, we have utilized a system from IKO which is the Polimar system, this is compatible with the mastic asphalt and can be used to carry out repairs and overlay the existing surface without any reaction. Therefore, we have allowed repairs to be carried out utilizing this system.

3.2.3. Roof access: Roof light: Provide strut to allow access safely onto and from the roof.

3.2.4. To lead cover flashings, repair torn sections and point up where cement pointing is cracked.

3.2.5. Slatework to mansards: Replace any slipped, broken or missing slates.

3.2.6. Guttering: Clear out the guttering and repair leaking joints, refix loose brackets.

AMBER PRIORITY: MEDIUM TERM (YEARS 3-5):

3.3. In terms of medium term actions, we would recommend the following:

3.3.1. Subject to the core test, we have allowed for the roof to be overlaid with a liquid plastic or felt covering (both are similar in cost), provision of additional insulation to improve the energy efficiency of the properties.

3.3.2. Associated works with any insulation upgrading would be to increase the upstand / kerb of the roof lights and any vent pipe penetrations. We would recommend at this time to replace the roof lights to provide a full system finish.

GREEN PRIORITY: LONGER TERM (YEARS 6-10):

3.4. In terms of longer term actions, we would recommend the following:

3.4.1. Assuming the works are carried out in the short and medium term as recommended, we would anticipate there will be only ongoing maintenance works required in the longer term.

4. CONCLUSION

4.1. In conclusion, based on our survey, repairs are required in the short term to the roof, and also in the medium term.

4.2. We refer you to our budget costs which highlight the short and medium term repairs required.

4.3. If you wish our further input or assistance in this regard, we would be delighted to do so.

4.4. We thank you for asking us to assist.

Prepared by F3 Building Surveyors Ltd.
26-Nov-21

Prepared by:	**SO**	Date:	
Checked by:	**RS**	**3-Dec-21**	

APPENDIX 1 – BUDGET COSTS

Description	Quantity	Units	Rate	Total	RED: Short Term	AMBER: Medium Term	GREEN: Longer Term
39 James Square Roofing							
SUPERSTRUCTURE							
Roof							
Roof coverings							
Flat Roof							
Asphalt covering - Core Test	1	Item	250	250.00	250.00		
Repairs to cracked sections.	3	Days	300	900.00	900.00		
Overlay Medium Term.	212	m2	110	23,320.00		23,320.00	
Medium Term Extra over for insulation	212	m2	50	10,600.00		10,600.00	
Medium Term Increased upstands	1	Item	3000	3,000.00		3,000.00	
Medium Term, remove existing chippings	212	m2	10	2,120.00		2,120.00	
Short Term - leadwork cover flashing repairs and re-sealing.	3	Days	300	900.00	900.00		
Short Term - Remove vegetation growth	1	Item	500	500.00	500.00		
Mansard							
Short Term - Replace slipped and missing slates, refix loose.	5	Days	300	1,500.00	1,500.00		
Roof drainage							
Guttering							
Clear out and repairs to leaking joints and leaking guttering.	1	Item	500	500.00	500.00		
Roof lights							
Roof Lights							
Medium Term - Replace large roof access hatch.	1	Item	2000	2,000.00		2,000.00	
Short term - Strut to roof access hatch.	1	Item	150	150.00	150.00		
Medium Term - Allowance for replacement roof lights.	6	No	1000	6,000.00		6,000.00	
PRELIMINARIES							
Facilitating Works							
Toxic / Hazardous / Contaminated Material Treatment							
Toxic / Hazardous Material Removal							
Asbestos Refurbishment Survey	1	Item	500	500.00	500.00		
Main Contractor's Preliminaries							
Scaffolding / Work at height							
Scaffolding Short Term							

Description	Quantity	Units	Rate	Total	RED: Short Term	AMBER: Medium Term	GREEN: Longer Term
To all Elevations to facilitate slatework and repairs to flat roof and guttering.	1	Item	6000	6,000.00	6,000.00		
Crash Deck internally	7	No	150	1,050.00	1,050.00		
Scaffolding Medium Term							
Medium Term for flat roofing. Tower and handrails.	1	Item	4000	4,000.00		4,000.00	
Crash Deck internally	7	No	150	1,050.00		1,050.00	
Management and General Preliminaries							
Short Term	4	wks	600	2,400.00	2,400.00		
Medium Term	8	wks	800	6,400.00		6,400.00	
SUB-TOTAL CONSTRUCTION COSTS				73,140.00	14,650.00	58,490.00	0.00
UNALLOCATED							
Unallocated							
Non-Construction Costs							
Professional Fees							
Short Term	1	Item	3000	3,000.00	3,000.00		
Medium Term	1	Item	4000	4,000.00		4,000.00	
TOTAL INCLUDING FEES				**80,140.00**	**17,650.00**	**62,490.00**	**0.00**
VAT			**20%**	**16,028.00**	**3,530.00**	**12,498.00**	**0.00**
TOTAL INCLUDING FEES AND VAT				**96,168.00**	**21,180.00**	**74,988.00**	**0.00**

APPENDIX 2 – STANDARD CONDITIONS

Content of the Report

In accordance with these terms the Surveyor will use his or her best endeavours to report upon:

a. The main aspects of the Property including assessing the site/location, the design, structural framework, fabric and services;

b. The grounds, boundaries and environmental aspects considered to affect the Property;

c. Any requirements for further investigation arising from the inspection.

Assumptions

Unless otherwise expressly agreed the Surveyor while preparing the Report will reasonably assume that:

a. The Building(s) (if for sale) is offered with vacant possession;

b. The Building(s) is connected to mains services with appropriate rights on a basis that is known and acceptable to the Client; and

c. Access to the Building(s) is as of right upon terms known and acceptable to the Client.

Scope of the inspection

A. Generally

a. The Surveyor will consider his or her advice carefully but is not required to advise on any matter the significance of which in relation to the Building(s) is not apparent at the time of inspection from the inspection itself.

b. The Surveyor will inspect diligently but is not required to undertake any action that would risk damage to the Building(s) or injury to himself, herself or any other party.

c. The Surveyor will not undertake any structural or other calculations.

d. The Surveyor will not produce a repair schedule, planned maintenance report, feasibility report or advise on design, procurement or project management unless expressly agreed with the client.

B. Accessibility

a. The Surveyor will inspect as much of the internal and external surface area of the building as is practicable but will not inspect those areas which are covered, unexposed or not reasonably accessible from within the site, or adjacent public areas.

b. The Surveyor is not required to move any obstruction to inspection including, but not limited to, fixtures, fittings and floor coverings.

c. The surveyor will not open up or cut into the building fabric without specific directions from the client. Such intrusive investigations, if instructed by the client, will be at the risk and liability of the client and will be assumed to be with agreement between the client and the building owner.

C. Floors

a. The Surveyor will lift accessible sample loose floorboards and trap doors, if any, which are not covered by heavy furniture, ply or hardboard, fitted carpets or other fixed floor coverings. The Surveyor will not attempt to cut or lift fixed floorboards or other floor fabric without the express permission of the owner.

D. Fixed covers or housings

a. The Surveyor will not attempt to remove securely fixed covers or housings without the express permission of the owner.

E. Roofs

a. The Surveyor will inspect the roof spaces if there is a safe working platform available to work from. Where no safe working platform or access is available, the roof spaces will not be inspected. Similarly, outer surfaces of the roof or adjacent areas will be inspected using binoculars, but will be excluded if they cannot be seen.

F. Boundaries, grounds and outbuildings

a. Where reasonable access is available the inspection will include boundaries, grounds and permanent outbuildings but will not include temporary buildings or structures.

G. Services

a. The Surveyor will carry out a visual inspection of the service installations where reasonably accessible. Drainage inspection covers will be lifted where they are reasonably accessible and it is safe and practicable to do so. No tests of the service installations will be carried out unless previously agreed, although general overall comments will be made where reasonably possible and practicable. The Surveyor will report if it is considered that tests are advisable. Specialist inspection of electrical installations or gas mains will not be undertaken.

H. Areas not inspected

a. The Surveyor will identify any areas which would normally be inspected but which he or she was unable to reasonably inspect.

I. Environmental and other issues

a. Particular noise, dust, flooding or contaminated land and disturbance affecting the Property will only be noted if it is reasonably significant at the time of the inspection or if specific investigation has been agreed between the Surveyor and the Client and confirmed in writing.

b. The Surveyor will report on any reasonably obvious health and safety hazards to the extent that they are apparent from elements of the Property considered as part of the inspection.

c. The Surveyor will not undertake a fire risk assessment or consider fire safety risks to the extent that they are apparent from elements of the property considered as part of the inspection.

J. Hazardous materials

a. Unless otherwise expressly stated in the Report, the Surveyor will assume that no deleterious or hazardous materials or techniques have been used in the construction of the Property. However, the Surveyor will advise in the Report if, in his or her view, there is a likelihood that deleterious material has been used in the construction and specific enquiries should then be made or tests carried out by a specialist.

b. Subject to section B to page 1, the Surveyor, based upon a limited visual inspection, will note and advise upon the presence of lead water supply pipes and asbestos.

c. The Surveyor will advise in the Report if, to the best of his or her knowledge, the Property is in an area where, based on information published by the National Radiological Protection Board, there is a risk of radon. In such cases the Surveyor may advise that tests should be carried out to establish the radon level.

d. The Surveyor will endeavour to advise if there are transformer stations or overhead power lines which might give rise to an electromagnetic field, either over the subject Property or visible immediately adjacent to the Property. The Surveyor is not required to assess any possible effect on health or to report on any underground cables.

K. Ground conditions

a. The Surveyor will not be required to comment upon the possible existence of noxious substances, landfill or mineral extraction implications, or other forms of contamination, nor will the Surveyor advise on the adequacy of the substratum for any particular purpose unless geotechnical tests or specialist advice are commissioned by the client.

L. Consents, approvals and searches

a. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that the Building or site is not subject to any unusual or onerous restrictions, obligations or covenants which apply to the Property or affect the reasonable enjoyment of the Property.

b. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that all planning, Building Regulations and other consents required in relation to the Property have been obtained. The Surveyor will not verify whether such consents have been obtained. Any enquiries should be made by the Client or the Client's legal advisers. Drawings and specifications will not be inspected by the Surveyor unless otherwise previously agreed.

c. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that the Property is unaffected by any matters which would be revealed by a Local Search and replies to the usual enquiries, or by a Statutory Notice, and that neither the Property, nor its condition, its use or its intended use, is or will be unlawful.

M. Exclusions

a. We have not inspected woodwork or other parts of the structure which are covered, unexposed or inaccessible and we are therefore unable to report that any such part of the property is free from defect.

b. We must stress that we have not carried out any investigation to determine whether any high alumina cement was used during the construction of the building inspected and we are therefore unable to report that the building is free from risk in this respect. In view of the possible potential danger connected with high alumina cement we strongly recommend that the appropriate investigations, inspections and tests be carried out immediately by a suitably qualified engineer.